Data-driven insights for a green, digital, healthy, strong and equal Europe

Please note that the webinar will be recorded.

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University of Vienna

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Welcome and house keeping

- Please mute your microphone when you are not speaking
- The session is being recorded
- Post your questions in the chat or raise your hand using the "raise your hand" function in Zoom ("Reactions" button)
- Need help? Write in the chat!
- Tell us how we did in the feedback form (more about that later)
- The materials (including the presentations) will be shared afterwards

Agenda

- NextGenerationEU: What is it, and why does it matter?
- Why do we need data-driven insights?
- How do we get data-driven insights?
- What data can we use for data-driven insights?
- Insights from the hackathon
- Communicating results effectively
- Q&A

Next Generation EU and the Recovery and Resilience Facility

- Next Generation EU
  - Recovery plan launched after the Covid19 pandemic
  - EUR 806.9 billion between 2021 and 2026 to drive Europe's recovery
  - Various individual, regional projects
    -> I4NG is one of many

- Recovery and Resilience Facility
  - Channels funds to member states
  - Focus on green transition and digital transformation

NextGenerationEU projects

News article | 20 May 2025

Making Connections: A New Tram Line for Tallinn's Old Port

Until recently, Tallinn's Old Port wasn't connected to the city centre by tram. With a NextGenerationEU investment of €36.5 million, things have changed, resulting in a more integrated public transport network, better infrastructural connections and improved quality of life for residents.

4 min read

Location

Estonia

News article | 16 April 2025

Air Support: Enhancing Firefighting Resources in Rural Portugal

Every year, wildfires wreak havoc in vulnerable areas of the Portuguese countryside. As part of enhanced fire suppression efforts, the country has invested €89 million of NextGenerationEU funding in resources and equipment, among which aerial assets for the Portuguese Air Force.

3 min read

Location

Portugal

News article | 24 March 2025

Growth Spurt: Boosting Childcare Supply in Belgium

In the French-speaking Walloon region to the country's south, Belgium has devoted €6 million in NextGenerationEU funding to the building and renovation of childcare facilities. The plan seeks to enhance the supply of childcare for working families, creating a fairer society for all.

4 min read

Location

Belgium

News article | 19 March 2025

The Right Move: Helping Persons with Disabilities Gain More Independence

Through a range of initiatives across the country, Italy is channelling €500 million in NextGenerationEU funding towards schemes that boost the autonomy and skills of persons with disabilities. In doing so, the country is making significant strides towards greater inclusivity.

3 min read

Location

Italy

News article | 20 February 2025

Rest and Recuperation: EV Charging Points in Luxembourg

Luxembourg has devoted over 80% of its NextGenerationEU funding allowance to climate-related objectives and clean energy solutions. As part of a nationwide grant scheme for EV charging points, the Europacamping facility now caters for cleaner mobility.

3 min read

Location

Luxembourg

News article | 25 October 2024

Mind the Gap: Bridging the Digital Divide in Latvian Schools

With an €11 million funding contribution made through NextGenerationEU, Latvia has launched a comprehensive initiative to distribute laptops to schools nationwide. The project is one of the country's flagship efforts to help bridge the digital divide.

3 min read

Screenshots from https://next-generation-eu.europa.eu/index_en

Infra4NextGen overview

€9.75m

ESS + 3 core research infrastructures: CESSDA, EVS, GGP

data + data summaries

MAKE IT GREEN DIGITAL HEALTHY STRONG EQUAL

5 thematic pillars

CITY ST GEORGE'S UNIVERSITY OF LONDON

University of Essex

GESIS Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences

UNIVERZA V LJUBLJANI

universität innsbruck

universität wien

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Next Generation EU Themes

MAKE IT

GREEN

DIGITAL

HEALTHY

STRONG

EQUAL

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Why do we need data-driven insights?
How do we get data-driven insights?
What data can you use?

What is evidence?

Research, evidence and policy making

- Evidence-based policies (EBP) / evidence-informed decision making (EIDM)
- Langer, Tripney and Gough, 2016: "[Research is] a systematic investigative process employed to increase or revise current knowledge."
- Evidence as a result of rigorous scientific research

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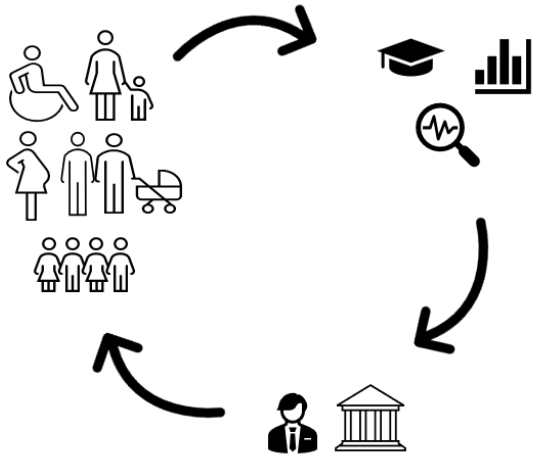
The need for data-driven insights

- Are evidence-based policies "better" than policies based on ideology?
- Parkhurst, 2016: “..pieces of evidence within decision-making processes that are **representative** of, and **accountable** to, populations served.”



The need for data-driven insights

- EP Thinktank and European Parliamentary Research Service publications
- Knowledge4Policy
- Joint Research Centre
  - Going beyond science communication, localising efforts, strategic impact, interactive support for researchers including a researchers' handbook

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How?

- Understand the institutional context of policy makers
- Skills needed to understand data-driven insights (OECD 2020)

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What data can you use?

ESS

CRONOS

GGP

EVS

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What data can you use?

- Go to the data inventory to check out variables, questions, and response items across various programmes!

- https://tool.infra4nextgen.eu/inventory.html

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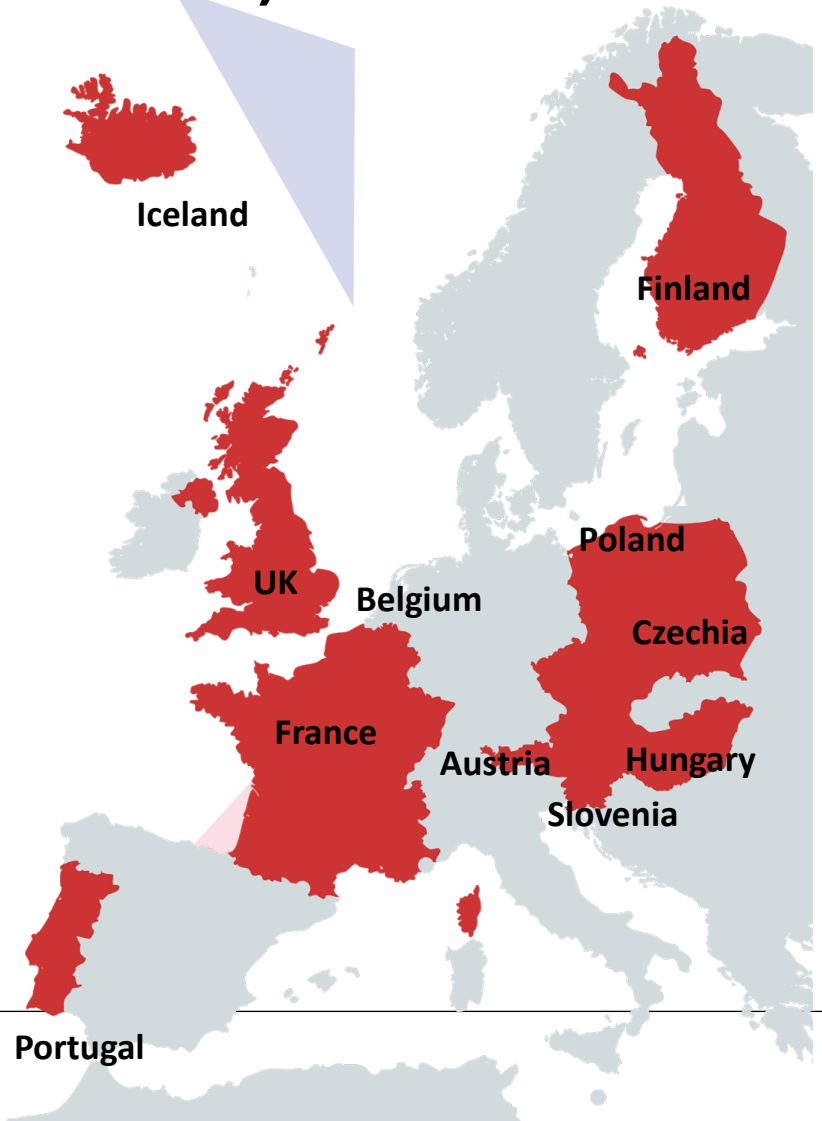
CROss-National Online Survey 3 (CRONOS-3) Panel

- Five waves of 90 questions (18 questions per wave for each NextGenEU pillar)
- Questions developed by ESS and subject area experts
- Recruitment from R10 and R11 main stage ESS interviews
- Fielded in 11 countries



Make it Equal

- beliefs about the causes and responsibility for inequalities
  - result of systemic injustice vs individual failings?
- public opinion on policy preferences for addressing inequalities
  - support for government intervention in wealth redistribution
  - role of government in ensuring equal access to opportunities.

Make it Healthy

- factors influencing both physical and mental health outcomes and their contribution to health disparities among different social groups
- work-life balance
- living conditions
- healthcare access and medication use
- availability and affordability of unhealthy products
- life stressors and lifestyle choices

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Make it Strong

- Education
  - fairness of educational opportunities
  - motivation to study science and technology
- Mobility
  - mobility preferences and experiences
  - attitude towards immigrants
- Work
  - job security and opportunities
- Values and public opinion
  - views on family and marriage
  - political orientations
  - trust in institutions and forms of active citizenship

Make it Digital

- digital connectivity
- digital skills and associated integration and stress factors in European societies and across different societal groups

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Make it Green

- public attitudes towards climate change, pro-environmental behavioural changes, and support for different climate policies
- public perceptions of responsibility and contributions to climate change mitigation
- Fairness of impacts and mitigation costs

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Insights from the hackathon

Invited speakers: Niklas Ippisch, Jakub Adamski, Sharon Baltazar, Carles Vañó-Agulló

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Mind the Gap: Why Inequality Perceptions Matter for Social Policy

Anna Fuchs and Niklas Ippisch,

LMU Munich

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Europeans and False Online Information

Jakub Adamski and Remigiusz Żulicki,
University of Lodz

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Bridging the Climate Commitment Gap: Securing Citizen Support for Climate Policy

Sharon S. Baltazar and Carles Vañó-Agulló,

CISOT-CIEMAT

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A policy brief should...

- communicate a relevant question/challenge/topic
- summarize findings
- might contain policy recommendations
- be brief and to the point

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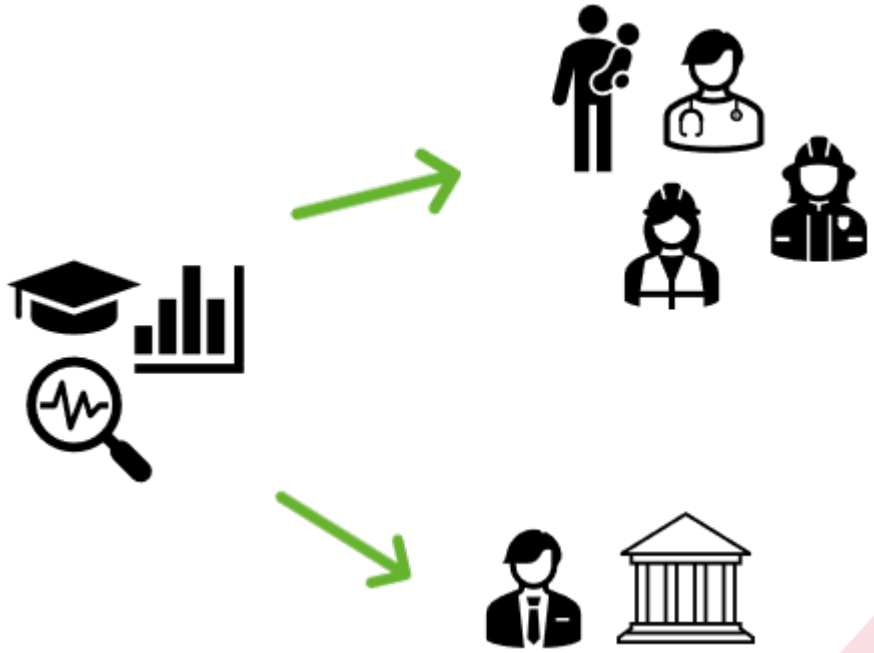
Effective Science Communication

- Tailored to the target group!



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Q&A

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Please fill out the feedback form!

Sign up to the I4NG Newsletter to receive all information about our upcoming events!

https://infra4nextgen.com/news/newsletter/

And check the events homepage (after the summer break!)

https://infra4nextgen.com/i4ng-events/forthcoming-events/

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Further Resources

- https://closer.ac.uk/policy-hub/templates/
- https://closer.ac.uk/policy-hub/templates/interactive-briefing-note-template -> to check out key points on how to write policy briefs
- Langer L, Tripney J, Gough D (2016). *The Science of Using Science: Researching the Use of Research Evidence in Decision-Making*. London: EPPI Centre, Social Science Research Unit, UCL Institute of Education, University College London. ISBN: 978-1-907345-88-3
- Newman J (2017) Deconstructing the debate over evidence-based policy, Critical Policy Studies, 11:2, 211-226, DOI: 10.1080/19460171.2016.1224724
- OECD (2020), Building Capacity for Evidence-Informed Policy-Making: Lessons from Country Experiences, OECD Public Governance Reviews, OECD Publishing, Paris, https://doi.org/10.1787/86331250-en.
- Parkhurst J (2016) *The Politics of Evidence: From evidence-based policy to the good governance of evidence.* Routledge, p. 197. ISBN 978-1-138-93940-0
- Standring A (2017) Evidence-based policymaking and the politics of neoliberal reason: a response to Newman, Critical Policy Studies, 11:2, 227-234, DOI:10.1080/19460171.2017.1304226

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CESSDA Training

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